VOL. 1 · NO. 26 PRINTED FOR DANIEL PRICE: ONE CUP OF COFFEE

The Morning Newspaper

MONDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

93° / 76°	Chance showers and thunderstorms, 26% rain, wind 5–10 mph	Tomorrow: 95° / 77°, partly sunny	Sunrise 7:30 · Sunset 19:04	Waxing crescent

Houthi Missile Barrage Pushes Saudi Oil Security, and Energy Markets, to the Brink

Strikes on two Saudi airports and an Aramco refinery have grounded flights and revived fears that the Red Sea's shipping and energy lanes are sliding back into open war.

WORLD & TECH

Musk's Midterm War Chest Tops $270 Million

WORLD · THE NEW YORK TIMES

Elon Musk has quietly become the single largest donor of the 2026 midterms, funneling more than $270 million into Republican campaigns and super PACs since July, including roughly $158 million to the Senate Leadership Fund. Allies say Musk is taking a lighter personal role this cycle than in 2024, content to let the money, rather than his own campaigning, do the work of trying to protect the GOP's narrow Senate majority heading into a difficult midterm map.

Microsoft Unveils Its Third-Generation Maia AI Chip

TECH · THE VERGE, VIA TECHMEME

Microsoft showed off the Maia 300, its third-generation in-house AI chip, built on TSMC's advanced N2P process node and positioned as the "primary AI inference system" across the company's data centers. The unveiling lands alongside a profile of Copilot chief Charles Lamanna, a potential successor to Satya Nadella, and reports that Microsoft is on pace to pay Anthropic more than $2 billion a year for AI capacity — a reminder of how much the software giant still leans on outside model makers even as it builds its own silicon.

Inside Amazon's Robotic Arms Race

TECH · ARS TECHNICA

Amazon, already the country's second-largest corporate employer, is pouring resources into warehouse robots that can pick, pack, lift and move goods with steadily less human help across its fulfillment network. The buildout raises familiar questions about what happens to the hundreds of thousands of warehouse workers whose jobs are exactly the ones machines are getting better and cheaper at doing, even as the company insists robots are filling gaps rather than replacing people outright.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,811.34	-0.00%
Dow Jones	51,725.38	+0.14%
Nasdaq	27,334.54	-0.12%
Russell 2000	2,802.50	-0.16%
VIX	15.40	+3.77%
10-yr yield	5.24	-0.08%
CRYPTO		
Bitcoin	$82,639	-0.44%
Ethereum	$2,529.51	+1.14%
STOCKS		
NVDA	$228.06	-0.53%
AAPL	$341.14	+1.34%
MSFT	$538.67	+0.67%
GOOGL	$353.95	+0.65%
AMZN	$261.25	-0.45%
META	$745.29	+3.71%
AVGO	$360.28	-0.35%
TSLA	$381.97	-0.19%
SPCX	$164.40	+1.13%
BRK-B	$516.61	+0.19%
TSM	$450.91	-0.53%

Major indices drifted near flat on a thin Columbus Day session, with the Dow up 0.14% while the Nasdaq and Russell 2000 both slipped modestly. The VIX rose almost 4% as the widening Houthi-Saudi conflict kept an oil-security premium baked into trading and investors weighed how exposed the Middle East's energy corridor has become after strikes on Saudi airports and an Aramco refinery. In Singapore, Broadcom's Hock Tan and Intel's Lip-Bu Tan warned that rising borrowing costs and tighter access to capital, not chip supply, could become the AI boom's real bottleneck, a worry that showed up unevenly across chip names even as Meta jumped nearly 4% on no chip news of its own and Nvidia and TSM each eased about half a percent. Bitcoin eased under $83,000 while Ether pushed higher, and the 10-year yield slipped to 5.24% in light holiday trading.

ON THIS DAY

1492: Christopher Columbus's expedition sighted land in the Bahamas, the voyage the United States still marks today as Columbus Day.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

AEON

Is everything conscious? — a philosopher asks whether the principle of sufficient reason quietly commits us to panpsychism.

NAUTILUS

A Distant Planet Emitted a Burst of Radio Waves. Why? — astronomers trace a 10-billion-year-old millisecond signal to its source.

TRICYCLE

Contemplations on the Five Mindfulness Trainings — two Plum Village teachers on holding to ethics amid injustice.

Generated 2026-10-12 08:54 by Claude Sources: RSS, NWS, Yahoo Finance, CoinGecko, web

AEON

Is everything conscious?

SAM KIMPTON-NYE · AEON.CO · OCT 12, 2026

A sharp walk through why an innocuous-looking logical principle might commit us to the idea that mind is everywhere.

When an explanation makes a fact intelligible, the mystery goes out of it. We understand it so well that we can hardly conceive of things being otherwise. Consider the simple mathematical fact that one plus one equals two. Once we understand elementary arithmetic, we no longer feel the urge to ask why one plus one equals two. That one plus one equals two strikes us as not merely true but unavoidable; we cannot even coherently imagine its falsity. Much of philosophy aims to bring other fundamental features of reality into a similar light, to make them appear not arbitrary but inevitable and, thus, intelligible.

This aspiration that philosophy render the world intelligible is best expressed by the German polymath Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz and the Dutch philosopher Baruch Spinoza. According to Leibniz: ‘we can find no true or existent fact … without there being a sufficient reason why it is thus and not otherwise.’ And, as Spinoza wrote: ‘For each thing there must be assigned a cause or reason, both for its existence and for its nonexistence.’ What’s being expressed here, in the words of the US philosopher Michael Della Rocca, is the desire ‘to make the world and our place in it intelligible’. To grasp the kinds of reasons or explanations sought by Leibniz and Spinoza ‘is the perennial hope and promise of philosophy’.

The demand for intelligibility can lead to some extraordinary places. For Leibniz, the demand led him to propose that reality is ultimately made up of a multiplicity of monads: indivisible, infinitesimally small units of substance, each of which is a causally isolated, self-contained universe. Spinoza’s resolute commitment to universal intelligibility led him to conclude that reality is, instead, a single infinite substance that he called God or nature.

Continued online (full article about 4573 words). Scan, or visit https://aeon.co/essays/does-the-principle-of-sufficient-reason-make-panpsychism-true

NAUTILUS

A Distant Planet Emitted a Burst of Radio Waves. Why?

MANISHA CALEB; THEMIYA NANAYAKKARA · NAUTIL.US · OCT 11, 2026

Astronomers finally pin down the origin of a 10-billion-year-old millisecond radio signal.

More than 10 billion years ago, something in a distant galaxy gave off an incredibly bright burst of radio waves which lasted just a few milliseconds.

In new research published today in Science, our team tracked it back to its origin in a small galaxy filled with many young stars, when the universe was only one-fifth of its current age.

Fast radio bursts like this one are a mystery scientists have been trying to unravel for almost 20 years since they were first discovered. Our discovery is the most distant such burst whose host galaxy has yet been identified.

Finding a Radio Signal from 10 Billion Years Ago

We detected the burst, dubbed FRB 20240304B, with the MeerKAT radio telescope in South Africa, using a system called MeerTRAP which is designed to catch fast-changing transient radio signals from space in real time.

The different frequencies of the radio burst arrived at slightly different times. We call this effect “dispersion”, and it happens because the signal has travelled through a lot of electrically charged material in space on its journey to Earth.

By measuring the amount of dispersion, we can tell how much of this material the signal has passed through – which in turn lets us calculate how far the signal has travelled and how far away from us it was created.

The FRB 20240304B burst showed a large amount of dispersion, which suggested it was probably coming from a great distance. We were also able to pinpoint its position on the sky.

But when we looked at that position with large ground-based telescopes like the Keck Telescopes, we couldn’t see a host galaxy. The galaxy was simply too faint.

Continued online (full article about 886 words). Scan, or visit https://nautil.us/a-distant-planet-emitted-a-burst-of-radio-waves-why-1285695/

TRICYCLE: THE BUDDHIST REVIEW

Contemplations on the Five Mindfulness Trainings

VALERIE BROWN; MARISELA B GOMEZ; MD · TRICYCLE.ORG · OCT 12, 2026

Two Plum Village teachers on using the precepts to stay ethical amid injustice and oppression.

Grief and love are deeply interconnected, and it was my experience of both that led me to write the article "Contemplations on the Five Mindfulness Trainings: A New Paradigm for Racial Justice and the Global Pandemic." I began writing in 2019 as I supported my brother, Sam, month after month during his treatment for chronic heart failure, which eventually led to his death in February 2020. I was not only grieving his death, but I was also mourning the end of my ambiguous and complicated fifteen-year marriage. This was followed by desperate months of quarantine, isolation, and physical distance due to the Covid pandemic. Each day revealed new and disturbing information about the disproportionate impact of Covid on Black and Latinx people, immigrants, and low-income communities. And then came the police killings of George Floyd, Breonna Taylor, and others; the worldwide and national protests calling to defund the police; and the expansion of the Black Lives Matter movement. As each event cascaded into the next, I knew instinctively to turn to the Plum Village mindfulness practice and teachings.

Months before, I had visited Blue Cliff Monastery, a mindfulness practice center in the Plum Village lineage in upstate New York. Just as I was about to walk to the front of the Great Togetherness Hall to offer a dharma talk, a nun had approached me and given me a copy of the Sutra on Transforming Violence and Fear. I turned to this sutra to help me understand my own feelings and the colliding events within the United States and beyond. I read and reflected on the sutra almost daily. Then I began reading the Third Mindfulness Training on True Love because love seemed distant and inaccessible, especially in light of my divorce.

Continued online (full article about 2870 words). Scan, or visit https://tricycle.org/article/five-mindfulness-trainings/